

Aloe vera, *for your porosity*

The same plant doesn't behave the same way on every head of hair. Here's how to get the gel out cleanly, then how to use it based on the way your hair drinks.

1 Getting the gel out

About 30 minutes — 25 of them waiting

1 Cut a leaf at the base

Take it from the bottom of the plant — those leaves are the most mature and hold the most gel.

3 Rinse, then take off the green skin

Cold water. Trim the spiny edges, then slice the skin off both sides with a knife.

5 Blend until smooth

No lumps — they dry into little white flakes in your hair.

2 Stand it upright to drain, 15 min

Cut end down in a glass. A yellow liquid runs out — that's aloin. Throw it away.

4 Soak the gel for 10 min

In a bowl of cold water, then rinse. This soak is what carries off the remaining bitterness.

6 Use it right away

Otherwise: 5 to 7 days in a sealed jar in the fridge, or frozen in cubes.

Skip neither the draining nor the soaking.

The yellow liquid irritates skin and scalp, and it is deeply bitter. If any is left, your mask will sting — that is not “the aloe working”, it is aloin that didn't come out. Always patch test on your inner elbow 24 h before the first use.

2 How to use it

Don't know your porosity?
schicgirl.me/blog/porosite-cheveux.html

Low porosity

Water beads on your hair. It takes a long time to get wet — and a long time to dry.

- Shower cap + gentle heat, 15 to 20 min
- Rinse warm, then cold
- No need to seal heavily after

Medium porosity

Your hair wets normally and holds moisture for a few days.

- Apply to wet hair
- 20 min, no heat
- Rinse cold, then a light leave-in

High porosity

Your hair drinks fast and dries fast. Moisture doesn't last the day.

- Add an oil to the mask
- 30 min under a shower cap
- Seal with butter or oil after rinsing

Why heat changes everything. On low porosity the cuticle lies tight: gentle heat lifts it just enough to let water through. On high porosity it is already open — heating does nothing, you need to close it instead, which is why the rinse is cold and the oil comes last.

Once a week is enough

Aloe hydrates, it doesn't nourish. It does not replace your deep conditioner.

Fresh gel ≠ shop gel

Homemade gel has no preservative at all. One week in the fridge, maximum.

If it stings, rinse

Rinse with clear water and don't go back to it. No treatment should burn.